

Curriculum Application & Student Challenges

How to Use This Module in Class

Pause the class during high-intensity physical drills (like holding a horse stance or plank) to have students check in on their physical tension. Remind them that mindfulness involves noticing body sensations without getting caught up in them.

Student Challenges — Integrate into Training:

- Stop and notice body tension during static stances (Horse stance, front stance).
- Check body awareness right before breaking a board or striking a heavy bag.
- Notice where you hold tension when you are tired or fatigued at the end of class.

Reflective Questions — Ask After Training:

- Where do you hold stress in your body when learning a new technique? (e.g., shoulders, jaw, fists)
- Can you distinguish between "good pain" (muscle exertion) and "bad pain" (injury or misalignment)?
- Did you feel off-balance at any point today? Where was your weight distributed?
- What happens to your speed when your muscles are tense versus when they are relaxed?

Module Summary: BODY

Scanning the Armor: A general body scan to identify and release held tension.

Finding Your True Center: Focus on balance, gravity, and preventing overextension.

The Clenched Fist: Contrast exercise teaching the difference between tension and relaxed readiness.

The Iron Root: Visualization to lower the center of gravity and increase stability.

The Puppet Master: Using imagery to align the spine without adding unnecessary tension.

